

BRENDAN PALKOWSKI

Grand Rapids, MI

palko.dev | github.com/bpalko | linkedin.com/in/brendan-palkowski

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Core: Go, Python, Bash, Kubernetes (operators, CRDs, Kubebuilder), Terraform, Helm, Crossplane, ArgoCD, Kargo, AWS, GCP

Infrastructure: Docker, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Postgres, Istio, Tyk, External Secrets, Kafka

Agentic: Cursor (self-hosted agents), Claude Code

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Jan. 2024 – Present

First American

Remote

- Removed Aurora cluster provisioning from the PR deployment critical path by building a Go Kubernetes operator that turns each preview into an isolated database tenant on the stable development cluster and manages its lifecycle from registration through cleanup.
- Built a Go Kubernetes operator that continuously reconciles RDS-managed Aurora credentials from AWS Secrets Manager into Crossplane-managed Kubernetes resources, preventing credential drift through rotation and disaster recovery.
- Built a policy-driven Kubernetes operator that automatically provisions and reconciles required Kubernetes compliance resources in labeled customer namespaces, eliminating per-application setup and correcting policy drift throughout the tenant lifecycle.
- Adopted Crossplane as the infrastructure API: custom resources and Helm packages for Aurora RDS/DocDB, S3, Redis, and IAM (Pod Identity), consumed by ~400 application tenants.
- Rolled out ArgoCD and Kargo as the Golden Path, moving releases from multi-month cycles to per-commit delivery. Every tenant depends on a Helm chart we maintain that abstracts platform features onto Kubernetes, including the Istio mesh, External Secrets, ingress via Tyk, and autoscaling.
- Technical Pod Lead for 3–8 engineers; platform on-call.

Cloud Engineer

Mar. 2022 – Jan. 2024

Alteryx

Remote

- Rebuilt the multi-cloud Terraform platform (GCP and AWS) across four platform accounts plus customer private data planes, and cut full environment builds from weeks to under 3 hours; wrote the architecture and runtime guide engineering used afterward.
- Wrote Go services to create and destroy split-plane clusters, generate manifests, template Terraform, and mirror GitLab projects.
- Technical lead for AI data-plane infrastructure in Terraform; onboarded teams onto Kubernetes, ArgoCD, and Helm.

Predictive Modeler

June 2020 – Mar. 2022

Auto-Owners Insurance

Lansing, MI

- Built and ran 70+ production microservice scrapers with Kafka and cron, used by underwriters for risk analysis.
- Migrated the department to Konvoy Kubernetes (production and non-production) and trained modelers on the new cluster.

EDUCATION

University of Michigan

Ann Arbor, MI

Bachelor of Science in Information Science

VOLUNTEER

Coding Instructor, [PiAcademy](https://PiAcademy.com)

Grand Rapids, MI

- Teach coding fundamentals through Raspberry Pi projects at a local youth tech nonprofit.